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Rail & cable

Fixed-guideway transit across Taiwan — metro and light rail in five cities, Taiwan Railway, High Speed Rail, the Maokong and Alishan cable and forestry lines.

The network

Every line on one map, drawn from official route geometry, with official colours, station counts, termini and end-to-end times.

Systems

Metro

31 pages

The metropolitan metro network — the lines a rider treats as one railway, under one numbering scheme and one fare system.

Cable

5 pages

The Maokong Gondola — an aerial ropeway run by a TRTC subsidiary, and the region's only cable transit.

Taichung Metro

26 pages

Taichung's Green Line — a single steel-wheel, driverless metro linking Beitun, the city centre and the HSR station.

Taiwan High Speed Rail

19 pages

Taiwan's 350 km high-speed railway, with 12 stations from Nangang to Zuoying and a BOT history that changed during financial restructuring.

Taoyuan Metro

52 pages

Taoyuan Metro's operating Airport MRT and the separate Green Line project registry published by the city engineering bureau.

Taiwan Railways

269 pages

Taiwan Railways current station and line data, with historical route architecture kept distinct from the live TDX snapshot.

Kaohsiung Metro

88 pages

Kaohsiung Metro's Red and Orange Lines and the Circular Light Rail, with TDX metro data and operator/government LRT records kept distinct.

Alishan Forest Railway

4 pages

Taiwan's 762 mm forest and mountain railway from Chiayi to Alishan, with active sunrise and forest-park branches.

Projects

Lines under construction, approved extensions, proposals and abandoned alignments.

Taipei-region rail projects

What is being built, what is approved, what remains a proposal, and what the primary record still cannot establish.

TOD and joint development

The station-area buildings, land rights, public returns and disputes that sit beside Taipei-region rail.

Taichung Metro Blue Line

Taichung's approved 24.78-kilometre east–west metro project, now entering route construction from the port toward the city centre.

Taichung Metro Purple Line

Taichung's feasibility-stage Tun District Loop project, planned as a 16-station elevated medium-capacity route linking Dali, Taiping, Beitun and Daqing.

Taichung Airport MRT Orange Line

Taichung's feasibility-approved airport-to-Wufeng MRT project, planned at approximately 29.23 km with 26 stations and still in pre-construction planning.

Taichung Orange Line Sea Line Extension

Feasibility-stage Orange Line extension toward Taichung's coastal districts, with an interim 16.50 km branching proposal that is not yet the approved route.

Taichung Metro Chongde–Fengyuan Line

Taichung's feasibility-stage Red Line, a proposed 15.42 km elevated route with 11 stations and a depot linking North Taichung, Tanzi and Fengyuan.

Taipei Metro Wanda–Zhonghe–Shulin Line

A two-phase medium-capacity route from central Taipei through Yonghe, Zhonghe, Tucheng and Shulin to Huilong, with construction dates and progress measures that must be read by phase.

"Sanmin Line" — no verified New Taipei project record

A checked source boundary for the requested Sanmin Line name; official records read in full identify Sanying and Minsheng–Xizhi as separate projects.

Minsheng–Xizhi Line

A cross-city LRRT project whose Taipei section remains in central review while the separately reported Xidong section is under construction.

Xinyi Line East Extension

A one-station underground extension from Xiangshan toward Guangci/Fengtian Temple, with the former Xinyi Road Sec. 6 station removed from the approved scope.

History

How the railway came to be the way it is — the contracts, disputes and decisions whose consequences are still running.

The Matra dispute

 Wenhua Line

Two disputes thirteen years apart, usually told as one — the test-track fires an engineering change explains, the seventeen-year lawsuit Matra won, and the walkout that taught Taipei how to buy its next railway.

Public art in the Taipei-region rail network

A primary-source catalogue of commissioned works named by DORTS, NTMC and TYMC, with missing fields and conflicting costs left visible.

The Circular Line's 0403 earthquake

 Circular Line

What the official investigation says about the 3 April 2024 earthquake: a pot-bearing mechanism, a design and inspection chain, the eight-month recovery, and a cause still disputed by the contractor.

Station naming and renames

Officially documented former names, appended station names and the gaps where a current label is not yet a rename record.

Metro incidents and service disruptions

A primary-source record of flooding, derailment, signalling faults, fires and earthquake disruptions, with unresolved counts and dates left visible.

The Linkou Line

A former Taiwan Railways corridor whose 1968 operation record, 2005 passenger opening and 2012–13 shutdown describe different phases of one railway.

The Shen'ao–Liandong Line

A former 6.0 km Taiwan Railways alignment whose southern section was dismantled in 1977 while the northern route later returned to passenger service.

The Hualien–Tianpu Line

A 2.4 km former Taiwan Railways alignment whose 1982 dismantling followed the East Line widening and the move from Hualien's old station.

The Taiwan Railways Taipei–Danshui Line

A 21.2 km former TRA route opened in 1901, left railway service in the 1988 era and began physical dismantling in 1989 before its corridor became MRT infrastructure.

The Taiwan Railways Xindian Line

A former 10.4 km Wanhua–Xindian railway, bought by the state in 1949, withdrawn in 1965 and later overlapped by roads and the Taipei Metro.

The Taiwan Railways Zhonghe Line

A former 6.5 km freight-only TRA branch from Banqiao to Zhonghe that opened in 1965, stopped service in 1990 and was physically dismantled in 1993.

The Taiwan Railways Fengyuan–Dongshi Line

A former 14.1 km TRA branch built in 1958, opened in 1959 and withdrawn after its final train on 31 August 1991.

The Taiwan Railways Tanzi–Shengang Line

An 8.7 km route listed in TRA's construction table alongside a roughly 14 km municipal greenway whose official histories disagree about the former railway's administrative identity.

The Taiwan Railways Ruifang–Shen'ao Line

A 6.3 km operator-table route with conflicting 1961 and 1965 opening records, passenger and freight service stopped in 1989, and passenger service restored on a shorter surviving route in 2014.

The Taiwan Railways Houtong–Sandiaoling Double Track

A 2.5 km double-track construction segment recorded by TRA as built in 1967 and opened in 1968, within the present Yilan Line corridor between Houtong and Sandiaoling.

The Taiwan Railways Changhua–Minxiong Double Track

A 71.7 km TRA construction-history segment recorded as built in 1957 and opened in 1970 with a double-track extension, kept separate from the current Western Main Line data layer.

The Taiwan Railways Chiayi–Xinshi Double Track

A 50.1 km TRA construction-history segment recorded as built in 1957 and opened in 1970 with a double-track extension, kept separate from the current Western Main Line data layer.

The Taiwan Railways Jianan–Taichung Port Construction Record

A 7.8 km TRA construction-history record for Jianan–Taichung Port, recorded in the operator PDF as constructed in 1973 and opened in 1974, while the current HTML history table omits the row.

The Taiwan Railways Xinpu–Tongxiao Double Track

A 5.8 km TRA construction-history segment recorded as built and opened in 1974 with an added second track, kept separate from the current Western Main Line data layer.

The Taiwan Railways Yuanli–Rinan Double Track

A 7.8 km TRA construction-history segment recorded as built and opened in 1974 with an added second track, kept separate from the current Western Main Line data layer.

The Taiwan Railways Jianan–Qingshui Double Track

A 6.0 km TRA construction-history record preserved in the operator PDF as built and opened in 1974 with an added second track, while the current HTML history table omits the row.

The Taiwan Railways Dajia–Jianan Double Track

A 5.3 km TRA construction-history segment recorded in the operator PDF as built in 1974 and opened in 1977 with an added second track, kept separate from the current station and line data.

The Taiwan Railways Dongshan–Su'aoxin Double Track

A 5.4 km TRA construction-history segment recorded in both operator presentations as built in 1974 and opened in 1977 with an added second track, while current TDX data places Xinma between its named endpoints.

The Taiwan Railways Sijiaoting–Ruifang Double Track

A 5.8 km TRA construction-history segment recorded in the operator's records as built in 1974 and opened in 1977 with an added second track, while current TDX data gives a separate 5.0 km endpoint-distance interval.

The Taiwan Railways Mudan–Shuangxi Double Track

A 3.1 km TRA construction-history segment recorded in the operator's records as built in 1974 and opened in 1978 with an added second track, while current TDX data gives a separate 3.4 km endpoint-distance interval.

The Taiwan Railways Hualien–Hualien Port Records

The operator records two Hualien–Hualien Port entries—4.0 km before Retrocession and 5.8 km for the later TRA construction completed in 1979—while a 2005 operating table retains the 5.8 km section.

The Taiwan Railways Hualien–Heping Construction Record

The operator records Hualien–Heping as a 39.4 km project opened in 1979 after construction in 1978, while its historical and current tables disagree on the constructor and current TDX endpoints measure 39.6 km.

The Taiwan Railways Heping–Su'aoxin Construction Record

The operator records Heping–Su'aoxin as a 39.8 km project opened in 1980 after construction in 1973, while its historical and current tables disagree on the constructor and current TDX endpoints measure 39.9 km.

The Taiwan Railways Hualien–Taitung Widening Record

The operator records the Hualien–Taitung widening as a 162.2 km project opened in 1982 after work in 1978, while current TDX endpoint fields cover 150.9 km between Hualien and Taitung.

The Taiwan Railways Hanben–Hualien Double-track Record

The operator records Hanben–Hualien as a 42.5 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau project built in 1992 and opened in 2003 with double-tracking, electrification, heavier rail and PC sleepers; current TDX endpoint fields measure 44.0 km.

The Taiwan Railways Hualien–Ruisui Reconstruction Record

The operator records Hualien–Ruisui as a 70.5 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau project built in 1992 and opened in 2003 with heavier rail and PC sleepers; current TDX endpoint fields measure 62.8 km.

The Taiwan Railways Su'aoxin–Hanben Double-track Record

The operator records Su'aoxin–Hanben as a 36.7 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau project built in 1993 and opened in 2004 with double-tracking; current TDX endpoint fields measure 35.5 km.

The Taiwan Railways Hualien Port Line Reconstruction Record

The operator records Hualien Port Line as a 10.5 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau project built in 1992 and opened in 2004 with heavier rail and PC sleepers; current TDX data supplies no named Hualien Port passenger endpoint.

The Taiwan Railways Songshan–Nangang Underground Record

The operator records Songshan–Nangang as a 7.7 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau project built in 1998 and opened in 2008 as railway underground; current TDX endpoint fields measure 2.8 km.

The Taiwan Railways Keelung Station Track-removal Records

The operator's historical PDF contains two TRA Keelung Station records—2.9 km from 1978 and 2.0 km from 1969—both tied to 27 April 2010 track removals; current TDX identifies Keelung as Western Main Line position 1.

The Taiwan Railways Zhuzhong–Liujia Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 3.1 km Railway Reconstruction Bureau Zhuzhong–Liujia double-track project with 2005 and 2011 year fields; current TDX keeps the two stations as the LJ line's 3.1 km ordered pair.

The Taiwan Railways Tao-yuan Station Track-removal Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 3.1 km Tao-yuan Station subject with 1969 and 1969 year fields and a May 2012 removal explanation for tracks 5–11, the loading line and the flour line.

The Taiwan Railways Longtian–Shanhua Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 3.8 km Longtian–Shanhua double-track subject with 2001 and 2013 year fields and a Zeng-Wun River Bridge new-construction explanation; current TDX fields span 6.8 km via Baling.

The Taiwan Railways Xinshi–Yongkang Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 2.9 km Xinshi–Yongkang double-track subject with 2009 and 2013 year fields and a Yan-shui River Bridge new-construction explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 5.0 km.

The Taiwan Railways Wuhe–Sanmin Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 1.6 km Wuhe–Sanmin single-track subject with 2013 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX exposes Sanmin but no Wuhe endpoint record.

The Taiwan Railways Sanmin–Yuli Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 4.1 km Sanmin–Yuli single-track subject with 2013 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 10.8 km.

The Taiwan Railways Dongli–Dongzhu Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 2.1 km Dongli–Dongzhu single-track subject with 2012 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 6.0 km.

The Taiwan Railways Dongzhu–Fuli Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 2.9 km Dongzhu–Fuli single-track subject with 2012 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 6.1 km.

The Taiwan Railways Chishang–Haiduan Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 0.3 km Chishang–Haiduan single-track subject with 2012 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 5.7 km.

The Taiwan Railways Haiduan–Ruiyuan Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 4.6 km Haiduan–Ruiyuan single-track subject with 2010 and 2013 year fields and a Hualien–Taitung railway electrification explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 16.7 km.

The Taiwan Railways Shanli–Taitung Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 7.3 km Shanli–Taitung double-track subject with 2010 and 2013 year fields and a double-tracking explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 8.2 km.

The Taiwan Railways Huatan–Shetou Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 4.3 km Huatan–Shetou double-track subject with 2006 and 2014 year fields and a Yuan-Lin Railway elevated explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 15.3 km.

The Taiwan Railways Jinlun–Taimali Single-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 1.9 km Jinlun–Taimali single-track subject with 2010 and 2014 year fields and a South-Taimail Bridge reconstruction explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 10.9 km.

The Taiwan Railways Pingtung–Chaozhou Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 16.3 km Pingtung–Chaozhou double-track subject with 2009 and 2015 year fields and a south-of-Pingtung railway-elevation explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 15.0 km.

The Taiwan Railways Shoufeng–Nanping Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 12.0 km Shoufeng–Nanping double-track subject with 2014 and 2015 year fields and an extension-to-double-track explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 11.2 km.

The Taiwan Railways Taoyuan Station Switching Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 0.3 km Taoyuan Station subject with 2015 construction and operation-start fields and a temporary-station switching explanation; current TDX places Taoyuan at Western Main Line position 21.

The Japanese-era trunk line, 1895–1945

How 臺灣總督府鐵道部 built the west-coast trunk line that became TRA — a 1908 completion at a gauge fixed years earlier under the Qing, two named stations lost to demolition and bombing, and a ten-week gap before the Republic of China's own railway administration took over.

The Taiwan Railways Shoufeng–Fengtian Double-track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 2.7 km Shoufeng–Fengtian double-track subject with 2015 and 2016 year fields and an extension-to-double-track explanation; current TDX endpoint fields span 2.8 km.

The Taiwan Railways Haikeguan–Badouzi Reopening Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 0.4 km Haikeguan–Badouzi subject with 2015 and 2016 year fields and a resumption-of-service explanation; current TDX places the two stations 0.4 km apart on the Shenao Line.

The Taiwan Sugar Railway network

A 762 mm network that reached roughly 3,244 km by 1952, carried passengers for 74 years until 1982, and survives today as five short tourist lines plus one still-working cane-hauling branch at Huwei.

Forestry railways beyond Alishan

Taipingshan, Baxianshan and the Luodong connector — three logging railway systems that moved timber out of Taiwan's mountains for six decades before ending in the 1960s-80s, with one short tourist stretch still running at Taipingshan.

The Taiwan Railways Shanhua Station Platform Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 0.3 km Shanhua Station subject with 2017 construction and operation-start fields and an Add platform explanation; current TDX places Shanhua at Western Main Line position 84.

Coal and mineral mining railways

The private colliery railway that became the Pingxi Line, and the separate gold and copper networks at Jinguashi and the coal railway at Houtong — three industrial systems whose Japanese-era origins are still visible in today's TRA branch and heritage sites.

The Taiwan Railways Sanmin Station Track Record

The operator's historical PDF records a 2.1 km Sanmin Station subject with 2010 construction and 2017 operation-start fields and an Add track explanation; current TDX places Sanmin at Eastern Main Line position 52.

Port rail connections — Kaohsiung, Keelung, Taichung

Kaohsiung's century-old harbour line closed in 2018 and was partly reused for light rail; Keelung's went silent by 2015; only Taichung's port branch still runs freight today, on a construction date that conflicts with its own operator's two histories.

The Taiwan Railways Donggang Line

A wartime naval branch to Pingtung County's coast, closed in 1991 after a bridge ended its reason to exist — and whose own operator record cannot currently be read.

The Taiwan Railways Old Mountain Line

The original, earthquake-scarred Sanyi–Houlong alignment, bypassed in 1998 because it was too difficult to double-track — now run by Miaoli County as a rail-bike attraction rather than by TRA.

The Ten Major Constructions and the THSR BOT crisis

Six transport projects launched in the 1970s under one banner, and a fundamentally different procurement model 25 years later for high speed rail — whose 2009 financial crisis a Control Yuan investigation called a "knockoff BOT" that left the government carrying nearly all the risk.

Technology

The technology layer — signalling, power, guideway and automation — and why Taipei runs several of each.

Metro systems and operations

Signalling, traction power, depots, service spacing, first and last trains, and platform doors across Taipei-region metro lines.

Three numbering systems on one line

BR Wenhu Line

Every Wenhu station has two numbers. On the southern half they run in opposite directions, and the northern half uses a different series again — because the line was built as two projects and a station was added to one of them late.

Metro depot maintenance levels

What Taipei's Level 1 through Level 5 depot labels actually describe, from pre-departure checks to network-wide overhaul.

Neihu Line steel running surface

Why the Neihu half of the Wenhu Line uses a pre-bent, coated steel running surface while the older Muzha half uses reinforced concrete.

Taipei Metro platform screen doors

How Taipei added platform screen doors to the early high-capacity network, and what the primary record does and does not say about completion by line.

Why the Wenhu Line looks the way it does

BR Wenhu Line

The official design logic behind the Wenhu Line's steel-and-glass stations, its three Neihu architectural vocabularies, and its river-in-the-sky idea.

Taipei-region metro automation grades

What GoA0 through GoA4 mean on Taipei-region railways, and which current lines have a published automation grade.

Taipei Metro signalling generations

The published boundary between Taipei's fixed-block high-capacity signalling and its later moving-block CBTC systems.

Taipei-region metro electrification

Voltage, collection method and traction-substation boundaries across Taipei Metro, New Taipei Metro and the Airport MRT.

Taipei-region metro control centres

What the three Taipei-region metro operators publish about their control-centre arrangements, and what remains undisclosed.

Taipei-region metro track gauges

The published gauge boundary between Taipei's steel-wheel metro, the rubber-tyred Wenhu system and New Taipei light rail.

Taipei Metro seismic design boundaries

The sourced chronology from Taipei Metro's early seismic basis through structure-specific design methods and the current national-code comparison.

Taipei-region metro fire and evacuation systems

The published boundaries between fire detection, smoke control, life-safety systems, vehicle egress, fixed escape paths and the 2025 Circular Line emergency response.

Operators

Who actually runs what — TRTC, New Taipei Metro, Taoyuan Metro, and eventually TRA and THSR.

Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation

The company that runs the Taipei Metro and the Maokong Gondola, separate from the government departments that build the lines.

New Taipei Metro Corporation

New Taipei City's operator of the Danhai, Ankeng and Circular light-rail systems, with the Sanying Line added to the operating record in 2026.

Taoyuan Metro Corporation

The company designated to run the Airport MRT, a public operator formed by Taoyuan, Taipei and New Taipei governments.

Taichung Metro Corporation

The city-owned operator of Taichung's Green Line, responsible for running the railway after the city and national agencies delivered its construction packages.

This section holds Taiwan's **fixed-guideway** systems: services that run on their own track or cable, to published stations, in a published order. That is the property metro, light rail, conventional rail, high speed rail and an aerial ropeway share, and it is what separates them from a bus route or a bike dock.

Below this heading the next level down is a **system**, not a page type. A system is a network with its own stations, its own numbering and its own fleet: the Taipei Metro network is one, Kaohsiung Rapid Transit another, Taiwan Railway and High Speed Rail two more. Lines, stations, rolling stock and depots belong to a system and are filed under it, so

that a TRA line does not have to share an index with the Wenhua Line. Operators, history and technology cut across systems — one company runs metro and light rail, one dispute shaped several lines — so they stay at this level rather than being copied into each.

The heading says "cable" as well as "rail" because some of these systems are ropeways or cable-hauled forestry railways, and calling them rail without qualification would be a small false claim in the furniture, which is the sort of thing this site keeps catching in itself.

Covered today: Taipei Metro [\[/rail/metro/\]](/rail/metro/) at entity level — its lines, stations, fleets and depots — with the Wenhua Line researched in particular depth; New Taipei Metro (TYMC) [\[/rail/tymc/\]](/rail/tymc/), Taichung Metro (TMRT) [\[/rail/tmrt/\]](/rail/tmrt/) and Kaohsiung Rapid Transit (KRTC) [\[/rail/krtc/\]](/rail/krtc/); Taiwan Railway (TRA) [\[/rail/tra/\]](/rail/tra/) and Taiwan High Speed Rail (THSR) [\[/rail/thsr/\]](/rail/thsr/); the Maokong Gondola [\[/rail/cable/\]](/rail/cable/) and the Alishan Forest Railway [\[/rail/alishan/\]](/rail/alishan/). Depth varies by system — see each system's own pages for what is TDX-backed and what is still TBC.

An independent, non-commercial reference site. Not affiliated with any transit operator or government body in Taiwan. Line colours are the official values published by each operator through Taiwan MOTC's open data platform. [About this site.](#)

Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.